

Dubai Marina Submarket Overview

Dubai Marina recorded 2,340 off-plan and secondary-market apartment transactions in H1 2026, up 9% year-on-year, according to aggregated Dubai Land Department transaction data. The submarket remains one of the three most liquid apartment markets in Dubai by transaction count, alongside Business Bay and Downtown Dubai.

Average price per square foot for 1BR units across the Marina reached approximately AED 2,480 in H1 2026, up from AED 2,260 a year earlier, driven in part by constrained new supply following a wave of completions between 2021 and 2023.

New off-plan launches in the immediate Marina waterfront have been scarce since 2021, with Marina Vista Residences and one other tower representing the only new waterfront-facing launches identified in this submarket over the past 18 months.

Rental Yield Analysis — 1BR Units

Gross rental yields for 1BR units in Dubai Marina averaged 6.6% in H1 2026, based on a sample of 140 active lease renewals and new-let transactions tracked across the submarket. Achieved annual rents for 1BR units of 700-800 sqft ranged from AED 110,000 to AED 145,000 depending on floor level, view, and building age.

After accounting for typical owners association service charges of AED 16-20 per sqft per annum in comparable towers, net yields for well-let 1BR units in the Marina typically fall in the range of 5.3% to 6.1%, before financing costs.

Occupancy for well-located 1BR stock in the Marina has remained above 92% through H1 2026, with average time-to-lease for newly handed-over units reported at under three weeks by two of the submarket's largest leasing brokerages.

Comparable Projects

Three recently completed or under-construction towers provide the closest comparables to Marina Vista Residences: Marina Bay Heights (completed 2023, average 1BR resale price/sqft AED 2,610), Waterside Residences (completed 2022, average 1BR resale price/sqft AED 2,390), and Marina Quay Tower (under construction, off-plan price/sqft AED 2,480 at last recorded launch pricing).

Marina Vista Residences' launch price of AED 2,550 per sqft sits within this comparable range, roughly 3% above Waterside Residences on a secondary-market basis but broadly in line with Marina Quay Tower's most recent off-plan pricing.

All three comparable towers report owners association service charges between AED 15.50 and AED 19.80 per sqft per annum, consistent with the AED 18 per sqft estimate disclosed for Marina Vista Residences.

Infrastructure Catalysts

The Roads and Transport Authority's planned Marina Promenade pedestrian upgrade, expected to complete in phases through 2027, will widen the waterfront walkway connecting Marina Walk to the JBR beachfront, an area planners expect to increase footfall to ground-floor retail along the route.

A previously announced feasibility study into a Dubai Metro Blue Line spur serving the Marina and JBR corridor remains at planning stage as of Q2 2026, with no confirmed construction timeline; investors should treat this as a longer-term, non-guaranteed catalyst rather than a near-term certainty.

Improvements to the Al Sufouh Road interchange with Sheikh Zayed Road, completed in late 2025, have measurably reduced peak-hour congestion for Marina residents commuting toward Downtown Dubai and DIFC.

Price Trend Forecast

Analysts tracking the Marina submarket project price-per-square-foot growth of 4-7% annually through 2028 for well-located waterfront stock, assuming no material change to Dubai's population growth trajectory or interest rate environment.

Absorption of new waterfront inventory has historically been rapid in the Marina; the two most recent comparable launches sold out their initial release phases within four and six months respectively.

Risks to the forecast include a broader slowdown in end-user mortgage lending should UAE interest rates rise materially, and the possibility of new waterfront supply being released on adjacent plots currently held for future development.